San Diego Regional Water Quality Control Board

September 24, 2019

In reply refer to / attn:
234117:CKomeylyan

Dr. Kyehee Kim, Ph.D., P.E.
County of San Diego Department of Public Works
Julian Wastewater Treatment Plant
5500 Overland Ave., Suite 315
San Diego, Ca 92123

Subject: **Notice of Applicability for Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ, Julian Wastewater Treatment Plant, Onsite Wastewater Treatment System**

Dr. Kim:

This letter is to inform the San Diego County Sanitation District (Discharger) that the Julian Wastewater Treatment Plant (Facility) Onsite Wastewater Treatment System (OWTS) is enrolled in State Water Resources Control Board Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ, *General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems* (General Order). The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, San Diego Region (San Diego Water Board) reviewed Order No. 83-09, *Waste Discharge Requirements for Julian Sanitation District, County of San Diego* and Addendum No. 1 to Order No. 83-09, *An Addendum Modifying the Requirements for Julian sanitation District, San Diego County* (collectively, Order No. 83-09) and the Discharger's record of compliance with Order No. 83-09. Based on the available information, the Facility meets the enrollment eligibility criteria included in the General Order. A copy of the General Order is available online at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

The Facility's enrollment in the General Order is effective upon adoption of San Diego Water Board Tentative Order No. R9-2019-0164, which rescinds Order No. 83-09. Adoption of Tentative Order No. R9-2019-0164 will be considered at the regularly scheduled San Diego Water Board meeting on October 9, 2019.

NOA Findings and Requirements - The Discharger is required to comply with all applicable requirements in the General Order and any additional requirements included in this Notice of Applicability (NOA).

1. **Facility and Discharge Description.** The Facility is located in the town of Julian, in San Diego County, within the Cuyamaca Hydrologic Area (907.43) of the San Diego Hydrologic Unit. The General Order and this NOA regulate the discharge of waste from small wastewater treatment systems and prescribe monitoring requirements for the treatment and discharge of domestic wastewater. The Facility OWTS consists of an equalization tank, headworks structures, two aeration tanks, two secondary clarifiers, two aerobic digesters, two effluent storage basins, an effluent wet-well, two sludge drying beds, and a waste activated sludge/return activated sludge pump station. The average flowrate for the Facility is approximately 80,000 gallons per day (gpd). The effluent is pumped and discharged to an adjacent onsite irrigation spray field. The groundwater quality monitoring network consists of five groundwater monitoring wells.

2. **California Environmental Quality Act.** The proposed project is the enrollment of the Facility in the General Order. As such, the project is categorically exempt from the requirements of the California Environmental Quality Act pursuant to title 14, California Code of Regulations, section 15301, and in compliance with title 14, California Code of Regulations, section 15300.2.

3. **Facility Specific Requirements.** The operator of the Facility must be familiar with the requirements contained in the General Order, this NOA, and the Monitoring and Reporting Program included in section 4 below.

   The General Order contains prohibitions and specifications, applicable to all wastewater systems, and specifications applicable only to specific treatment and disposal systems. This NOA permits an average daily flow rate of 80,000 gpd, calculated monthly. The Discharger must comply with the following specific requirements:

   a. Required Technical Reports/Plans. The Discharger must submit the plans described below:

      i. **Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan.** Consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.a., the Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan must be received by the San Diego Water Board by **5:00 p.m. on January 7, 2020**.

      ii. **Sampling and Analysis Plan.** Consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.b, the Sampling and Analysis Plan must be received by the San Diego Water Board by **5:00 p.m. on January 7, 2020**.

      iii. **Sludge Management Plan.** Consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.c, the Sludge Management Plan must be received by the San Diego Water Board by **5:00 p.m. on January 7, 2020**.

Upon approval of the plans by the San Diego Water Board, the Discharger must implement the plans.

b. Applicable Requirements of the General Order. The Discharger must comply with sections B.3 and B.4 (Aerobic Treatment Units and Activated Sludge Systems) of the General Order. General Order B.3 and B.4 requirements include but are not limited to the following: submission of a sludge management plan, communication to customers that discourages the use of holding tank chemicals, and ensuring all upgrades and repairs to the OWTS are performed by licensed professionals.

   The Discharger must comply with section B.7 (Land Application and/or Recycled Water Systems) of the General Order, which limits when effluent may be discharged depending on rain and wind conditions, as well as restricting public access to the spray field area.

   The Discharger must also comply with section B.8 (Sludge/Solids/Biosolids Disposal) which includes requirements for the proper management and disposal of sludge wastes.

   The Discharger must also comply with section B.12 (Wastewater Pond Monitoring) of the General Order when the percolation pond is in use. The requirements for monitoring the pond are listed in section 5.f below.

c. Setback Requirements. New discharges must maintain the applicable setbacks specified in Table 3 of the General Order.

4. EFFLUENT LIMITATIONS

The Discharger must not allow effluent concentrations to exceed the following parameters listed in the table below:

Table 1. Effluent Limitations

Constituent	Units	Limit
Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD)	milligrams per liter (mg/L)	30 (monthly average), 45 (7-day average)
Total Suspended Solids (TSS)	mg/L	30 (monthly average), 45 (7-day average)
Total Nitrogen as Nitrogen	mg/L	50%*
Monthly Average of Daily Flowrate	gpd	80,000

Table Note:
* The value represents the minimum percent reduction compared to the untreated wastewater value. Reduction must be calculated on an annual basis. The reduction shall not result in an effluent limit lower than 10 mg/L total nitrogen.

5. **Monitoring and Reporting Program.** The Discharger must comply with the monitoring and reporting requirements below, which are included in the monitoring requirements of the General Order.

   a. Reporting Frequency. Submit quarterly and annual monitoring reports as described in sections A and B of Attachment C to the General Order, respectively. The first quarterly report will be the October - December 2019 Quarterly Report, which must be submitted to the San Diego Water Board by **5:00 p.m. on January 2, 2020**. The reporting period for this quarterly report will begin on the effective date of this NOA. The first annual report will be the 2019 Annual Report, which must be submitted to the San Diego Water Board by **5:00 p.m. March 2, 2020**.

   b. Influent Quality Monitoring. A liquid grab sample must be collected at the beginning of the treatment system and the samples must be analyzed and results reported as described in Table 2 below:

Table 2: Influent Quality Monitoring

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sample Frequency*	Reporting Frequency*
Total Nitrogen as Nitrogen	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly	Quarterly

Table Notes:

* Quarterly is defined as a period of three consecutive calendar months beginning on January 1, April 1, July 1, and October 1.

   c. Effluent Quality Monitoring. A liquid grab sample must be collected at the end of the treatment system and the samples must be analyzed and results reported as described in Table 3 below:

Table 3: Effluent Quality Monitoring

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sample Frequency[b]	Reporting Frequency[b]
Flow Rate[a]	gpd	Meter	Continuous	Quarterly
BOD	mg/L	Grab	Monthly	Quarterly
TSS[c]	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly	Quarterly
Total Nitrogen as Nitrogen	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly	Quarterly
Total Dissolved Solids (TDS)	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly	Quarterly

Table Notes:

a. At a minimum, daily average flow rate must be calculated monthly using total flow for the month divided by the number of days in the month. Flow rate may be metered or estimated based on potable water supply meter readings or other approved method.

b. Quarterly is defined as a period of three consecutive calendar months beginning on January 1, April 1, July 1, and October 1.

c. If tank was pumped within the year, then no sampling of TSS is required.

d. Groundwater Monitoring. The groundwater must also be monitored as described in Table 4 below:

Table 4: Groundwater Monitoring

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sample Frequency[b]	Reporting Frequency[a,c]
TDS	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly	Annually
Nitrate	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly	Annually

Table Notes:

a. Annually is defined as a period of 12 consecutive calendar months beginning on January 1.
b. Quarterly is defined as a period of three consecutive calendar months beginning on January 1, April 1, July 1, and October 1.
c. Monitoring for TDS and Nitrate can be assessed by the Discharger after eight reporting periods and a request for reduction in monitoring frequency, as appropriate, submitted to the San Diego Water Board in writing.

e. Land Application Areas (LAAs). The Discharger must monitor LAAs when wastewater and/or supplemental irrigation water is applied. If wastewater or supplemental irrigation is applied during a reporting period, the monitoring report must so state. LAA monitoring must consist of the following:

Table 5. LAAs

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sample Frequency	Reporting Frequency
Supplemental Irrigation	gpd	Meter [a]	Monthly	Quarterly
Wastewater Flow [a]	gpd	Meter [a]	Monthly	Quarterly
Local Rainfall	Inches	Weather Station [b]	Monthly	Quarterly
Acreage Applied [c]	Acres	Calculated	Monthly	Quarterly
Application Rate [d]	gallons/acre/month	Calculated	Monthly	Quarterly
Soil Erosion Evidence	--	Observation	Monthly	Quarterly
Containment Berm Condition	--	Observation	Monthly	Quarterly
Soil Saturation/Ponding	--	Observation	Monthly	Quarterly
Nuisance Odors/Vectors	--	Observation	Monthly	Quarterly
Discharge Off-Site	--	Observation	Monthly	Quarterly

Table Notes:

a. Meter requires reading a pump run time meter, or approved method.
b. Weather station may be site-specific station or nearby government weather reporting station.
c. Acreage applied denotes the acreage to which wastewater is applied.
d. Application rate may also be reported as inch/acre/month.

f. Wastewater Storage Pond Monitoring. The Discharger must monitor the wastewater pond system when the pond is in use. Wastewater pond monitoring must consist of the following:

Table 6: Wastewater Storage Pond Monitoring

Constituent	Units	Sample Type	Sample Frequency [a, b]	Reporting Frequency [b, c]
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	Grab	Quarterly	Quarterly
Freeboard			Quarterly	Quarterly
Odors			Quarterly	Quarterly
Berm Conditions			Quarterly	Quarterly

Table Notes:

a. Monthly is defined as a calendar month.
b. Annually is defined as a period of 12 consecutive calendar months beginning on January 1.
c. Quarterly is defined as a period of three consecutive calendar months beginning on January 1, April 1, July 1, or October 1.

6. **Volumetric Monitoring Requirements**. The Discharger must report the following information in accordance with section 3 of the *Water Quality Control Policy for Recycled Water*.

a. Influent Monitoring. Monthly volume of wastewater collected and treated by the wastewater treatment plant.

b. Production. Monthly volume of wastewater treated, specifying level of treatment.

c. Discharge. Monthly volume of treated wastewater discharged to each of the following, specifying level of treatment:

1. Inland surface waters, specifying volume required to maintain minimum instream flow.
2. Enclosed bays, estuaries and coastal lagoons, and ocean waters.
3. Natural systems, such as wetlands, wildlife habitats, and duck clubs, where augmentation or restoration has occurred, and that are not part of a wastewater treatment plant or water recycling water treatment plant.
4. Underground injection wells, such as those classified by U.S. EPA's Underground Injection Control Program, excluding groundwater recharge via subsurface application intended to reduce seawater intrusion into a coastal aquifer with a seawater interface.
5. Land, where beneficial use is not taking place, including evaporation or percolation ponds, overland flow, or spray irrigation disposal, excluding pasture or fields with harvested crops.

Dischargers are required to submit the volumetric data to GeoTracker by April 30 of each year and must include data for the previous year.

7. **Change in Ownership.** In the event of any change in control or ownership of the Facility or wastewater disposal areas, the Discharger must notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this General Order by letter, a copy of which must be immediately forwarded to the Executive Officer for the San Diego Water Board.

8. **Enforcement.** Please review this NOA carefully to ensure it completely and accurately reflects the discharge. If the Discharger violates the terms or conditions listed in the NOA or the General Order, the San Diego Water Board may take enforcement actions, including imposition of monetary penalties in the form of an administrative civil liability assessment under Water Code section 13323 et seq. and 13350 et seq. Prior to allowing changes to the wastewater strength, generation rate, or changes to the method of waste disposal, the Discharger must contact the San Diego Water Board to determine if submittal of a Report of Waste Discharge is required.

   The Discharger is responsible for compliance with the General Order and this NOA. Failure to comply with the requirements in the General Order or this NOA could result in an enforcement action as authorized under Water Code section 13000 et seq. Discharges of wastes other than domestic wastewater are prohibited.

9. **Annual Fees.** The discharge has a threat to water quality and complexity rating of 2-B. The annual fee corresponding to a threat to water quality and complexity of 2-B can be found using the current fee schedule;[1] The fee is due on an annual basis until enrollment in the General Order is terminated. If the permitted wastewater discharge ceases, the Discharger must provide written notice to enable the San Diego Water Board to terminate enrollment and billing.

Please review the conditions specified in this NOA and applicable sections of the General Order and notify the San Diego Water Board if the Facility is unable to comply with any of the specified conditions.

Please submit all monitoring reports and documents required by the General Order and this NOA to the San Diego Water Board by email to sandiego@waterboards.ca.gov. Email submittals must include a signed cover letter with the facility name, facility contact information, and reference code **234117:CKomeylyan**. Routine email correspondence may be sent directly to individual San Diego Water Board staff members.

Documents that are 50 megabytes or larger must be transferred to a compact disk (CD) and mailed to the San Diego Water Board. Please ensure the files on the CD are not password protected. San Diego Water Board staff may request specific individual items, such as technical report appendices, large drawings, grading plans, or maps, be provided in paper format. If you have any specific questions about email submittal

[1] http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/resources/fees/water_quality/

procedures please contact our Mission Support Services staff, by phone at (619) 516-1990, or by email at sandiego@waterboards.ca.gov.

Please contact Ms. Sherrie Komeylyan by phone at (619) 521-3366, or by email at Chehreh.Komeylyan@waterboards.ca.gov if you have any questions or comments.

Respectfully,

for
David W. Gibson
Executive Officer

DG:jgs:kkd:rnm:ck

cc (via email): Dr. Kyehee Kim, Department of Public Works, County of San Diego, Kyehee.kim@sdcounty.ca.gov

Tech Staff Info & Use

New Reg. Measure ID:	426856
Place ID:	234117
Party ID:	39607
PCA Code:	12601
FI$CAL:	A32000